

Team Workbook

Cedarline Health Group — Hybrid Mesh Firewall design exercise

Cedarline Health Group is a regional healthcare payer-provider — roughly 8,000 employees across four hospitals and thirty-one clinics, plus a claims-processing business that handles the money. Growth by acquisition (including a second data centre absorbed as-is) and a mid-flight, disorderly move to public cloud have left a fragmented security posture. After a security incident in March, the board asked what would have stopped it — and leadership still cannot answer. Budget and executive attention are approved, but explicitly temporary, and the security team is small.

Your team acts as Cisco Solution Engineers. Work each Case Study below: for every pain point, name the Cisco product/platform that fits and write the Solution-Engineer response — how it addresses Cedarline's concern and how it helps — then bring it together as a Hybrid Mesh Firewall design.

TEAM NAME

MEMBERS

DATE

Case Study 1 · AI Security

Case Study 2 · Cloud Edge

Case Study 3 · DC Edge

Case Study 4 · Segmentation

Four Case Studies · four pain points each

Each Case Study is a real conversation with Cedarline. For every pain point, fill in two things:

- **Product / Platform** — the Cisco product or platform you would bring to this concern.
- **Solution Engineer response** — in your own words, how it addresses the concern *and* how it helps Cedarline. Be specific to their constraints (regulated data, small team, mid-flight cloud migration, inherited estate).

Scoring. Each Case Study is worth 100 points (25 per pain point) for a total of **400**. Points reward naming an appropriate product **and** Solution-Engineer reasoning that fits Cedarline — not generic statements.

How you'll be scored — three levels

Each answer is graded at one of three levels. Aim for **Expert** on every pain point.

Associate 6–13

Name the right **product** and show you understand the problem.

Professional 14–20

Also explain **how** the product addresses the concern.

Expert 21–25

Also tie it to Cedarline's specifics and the **outcome**, and how it fits the wider HMF design.

At the end, you'll bring your four Case Studies together into one Hybrid Mesh Firewall topology — there's a full-page space to paste or draw your team's diagram.

1

CASE STUDY 1

AI Security

The situation. Cedarline is standing up AI across regulated workflows and public cloud faster than security can see it. Help them prove compliance, vet what they adopt, and get visibility and guardrails over AI traffic.

PAIN POINT 1 Case Study 1 · AI Security

Under the EU AI Act, we are classified as a 'Provider' for our internal AI systems. We need to demonstrate robustness and cybersecurity compliance to satisfy Article 15. How does Cisco help us meet these specific requirements?

PRODUCT / PLATFORM

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SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN & HOW IT HELPS

PAIN POINT 2 Case Study 1 · AI Security

We are integrating various open-source models and third-party agents into our internal workflows. How can we ensure these assets aren't introducing vulnerabilities into our environment before they even go live?

PRODUCT / PLATFORM

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SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN & HOW IT HELPS

PAIN POINT 3

Case Study 1 · AI Security

We know AI is showing up across our cloud environments faster than security can track it. We're worried we have models, agents, datasets, and MCP-connected tools running without visibility or consistent controls.

PRODUCT / PLATFORM

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SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN & HOW IT HELPS

PAIN POINT 4

Case Study 1 · AI Security

We're running AI workloads in cloud accounts, but we don't have a reliable way to see which models and AI assets are actually in use. We're also concerned about workloads reaching out to third-party AI models without security knowing about it. And even when we do know the traffic path, we need a practical way to inspect and enforce guardrails on prompt and response traffic in the cloud without changing every application.

PRODUCT / PLATFORM

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SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN & HOW IT HELPS

2

CASE STUDY 2

Cloud Edge

The situation. Workloads sprawl across AWS, Azure and on-prem, each with its own policy model. Contain lateral movement, prove consistent controls to auditors, and give Cedarline one place to define and enforce policy.

PAIN POINT 1 Case Study 2 · Cloud Edge

If a breach occurs in one of our public cloud instances, we are terrified that the attacker will move laterally into our core on-premises systems. How can we contain these threats in a multicloud environment?

PRODUCT / PLATFORM

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SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN & HOW IT HELPS

PAIN POINT 2 Case Study 2 · Cloud Edge

Our auditors require proof that our security controls are applied consistently across all our cloud workloads. Gathering this data from different cloud providers is a manual, time-consuming nightmare.

PRODUCT / PLATFORM

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SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN & HOW IT HELPS

PAIN POINT 3

Case Study 2 · Cloud Edge

We have workloads spread across AWS, Azure, and on-premises data centers. Managing security policies individually in each cloud environment is creating massive operational overhead and leading to inconsistent security posture.

PRODUCT / PLATFORM

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SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN & HOW IT HELPS

PAIN POINT 4

Case Study 2 · Cloud Edge

We have workloads on-prem, in cloud, and in mixed environments, and policy consistency is becoming difficult. Every environment feels different, and we're worried about drift.

PRODUCT / PLATFORM

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SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN & HOW IT HELPS

3

CASE STUDY 3

DC Edge — Perimeter Firewall

The situation. A mixed-vendor perimeter, an inherited rulebase and mostly-encrypted traffic leave blind spots and slow response. Restore visibility, speed the response, and modernise detection with the team they have.

PAIN POINT 1 Case Study 3 · DC Edge — Perimeter Firewall

When our security tools detect a compromised device, our manual response time is too slow. By the time we identify the user and manually isolate the port, the attacker has already moved through the network.

PRODUCT / PLATFORM

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SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN & HOW IT HELPS

PAIN POINT 2 Case Study 3 · DC Edge — Perimeter Firewall

Our firewall environment has become too complex to manage manually.

PRODUCT / PLATFORM

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SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN & HOW IT HELPS

PAIN POINT 3

Case Study 3 · DC Edge — Perimeter Firewall

Most of our traffic is encrypted, so we've lost visibility into a huge part of our environment.

PRODUCT / PLATFORM

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SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN & HOW IT HELPS

PAIN POINT 4

Case Study 3 · DC Edge — Perimeter Firewall

We're worried traditional signature-based detection won't catch new or unknown attacks quickly enough.

PRODUCT / PLATFORM

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SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN & HOW IT HELPS

4

CASE STUDY 4

Macro & Micro Segmentation

The situation. A flat data centre and fragmented Kubernetes networking invite east-west movement. Build segmentation Cedarline can adopt safely — with runtime visibility and application-dependency awareness so nothing breaks.

PAIN POINT 1 Case Study 4 · Macro & Micro Segmentation

Network policy helps, but we also need to know what's happening at runtime inside the workload. We need better detection of suspicious behavior and policy violations.

PRODUCT / PLATFORM

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SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN & HOW IT HELPS

PAIN POINT 2 Case Study 4 · Macro & Micro Segmentation

Our Kubernetes networking feels fragmented across clusters and environments. We're dealing with too many moving parts, inconsistent policies, and too much operational complexity.

PRODUCT / PLATFORM

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SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN & HOW IT HELPS

PAIN POINT 3

Case Study 4 · Macro & Micro Segmentation

Right now we're stitching together separate tools for networking, security, and observability in Kubernetes, and it's creating too much overhead.

PRODUCT / PLATFORM

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SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN & HOW IT HELPS

PAIN POINT 4

Case Study 4 · Macro & Micro Segmentation

We know we need microsegmentation, but we don't have enough visibility into east-west flows or application dependencies to create policy safely. We don't want to break the application.

PRODUCT / PLATFORM

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SOLUTION ENGINEER RESPONSE — HOW IT ADDRESSES THE CONCERN & HOW IT HELPS

Your Hybrid Mesh Firewall topology

Combine your four Case Studies into one design. Paste your team's topology diagram in the space below (or sketch it by hand), and be ready to walk the room through it.



Paste your team's topology diagram here

Show how AI Security, Cloud Edge, DC Edge and Segmentation fit together across Cedarline's on-prem, data-centre and multicloud estate.